# Nicholas Rode

## Product & Interactive Motion Designer

theniceguynick@gmail.com · 281.794.1242 · Vancouver, WA · Portfolio · Motion Reel

### SUMMARY

Motion engineer and interactive motion designer with 5+ years of experience shipping motion for B2B SaaS and tech brands. I turn complex products into clear, engaging motion, ship it production-ready, fast, and accessible across Rive, Lottie, and the web, and build AI-powered tools that remove friction between design and development.

### EXPERIENCE

**Motion Engineer, Webstacks** Jan 2025 – Present

*B2B web design and development agency · Promoted from Motion Designer, Oct 2026*

- Shipped interactive motion, animation, and illustration for Gong and Fireworks AI, including product UI motion for Fireworks AI
- Built 4 interactive Rive product demos for Deepgram's AI voice platform: voice-to-text, voice avatars, assistant states, and a Slack integration walkthrough
- Designed a 10-piece Rive animation system for Shep's rebrand, turning automation, security, and scale into one visual language
- Choose and optimize animation runtimes for mobile web performance
- Ship production Rive state machines with reduced-motion support and cross-device playback

**Junior Designer (Product UI & Motion), Variable Medium** Jan 2021 – Dec 2024

- Designed the desktop and mobile peer-to-peer trading app for Evaluate, from interactive prototypes for user testing through launch, plus its marketing site and onboarding video
- Designed trade and chat flows, including asynchronous offers with expiry dates so traders don't need to be online at the same time
- Built advanced interactive prototypes for user testing and developer handoff
- Contributed to design system development and created motion that clarified complex product flows

**Freelance Motion Designer & Illustrator, Self-employed** 2022 – Present

- Deliver motion graphics, illustration, and web and mobile design for tech, SaaS, and B2B clients

### TOOLS I'VE BUILT

**Stroke Center (Figma Community):** Plugin that converts inside/outside strokes to center for clean Lottie export.

**Design to Webpage:** AI skill that turns Figma designs into working HTML prototypes with interactions and motion.

**Sequence to Shader:** AI-built pipeline that turns After Effects renders into lightweight WebGL shaders.

**Figma → React:** Figma plugin that generates reliable React code from designs.

### SKILLS

**Motion & interaction:** Rive (state machines, interactive components), After Effects, Lottie/Bodymovin, UI animation, 2D/3D animation, compositing

**Design:** Figma (including motion), Illustrator, UI/UX design, design systems, interactive prototyping

**Production & performance:** Rive web runtimes (React, Canvas, WebGL2), Lottie JSON delivery, WebGL shaders, Lighthouse performance tuning, reduced-motion accessibility, developer handoff

**AI & building:** Claude Code, AI-assisted tool building, Figma plugin development

### EDUCATION

**Art Institute of Seattle**

**Nucamp, Full Stack Web Design** 2020

### COURSES

Rive Masterclass

TheMotionMagic, Ultimate Rive Animation Course

School of Motion, A Motion Design Masterpiece